

Word family: **punish / punished / punishing / punishment / punishable / punitive / punitively / impunity**

Base word: punish

Part of speech: **verb**

Related forms:

* **punish** (v.) — 懲罰；處罰；使因某行為承受不利後果

* **punished** (adj./participle) — 被懲罰的

* **punishing** (adj.) — 嚴酷的；令人筋疲力竭的；負擔沉重的

* **punishment** (n.) — 懲罰；處罰；刑罰

* **punishable** (adj.) — 可受懲罰的；依法可處罰的

* **punitive** (adj.) — 懲罰性的；嚴厲到帶有懲罰意味的

* **punitively** (adv.) — 以懲罰方式；懲罰性地

* **impunity** (n.) — 免受懲罰；逍遙法外

Major/useful expressions and extensions:

punish someone, punish someone for something, punish someone for doing something, punish wrongdoing, punish bad behaviour, punish severely/harshly, punish unfairly, punish innocent people, punish yourself, punish the customer, feel punished, be punished for doing the right thing, punishment for something, impose punishment, receive punishment, escape punishment, avoid punishment, severe/harsh punishment, appropriate punishment, disciplinary punishment, corporal punishment, capital punishment, collective punishment, cruel and unusual punishment, punishable offence, punishable by law, punishable by imprisonment/a fine, punitive measure, punitive action, punitive penalty, punitive damages, punitive fine, punitive charge, punitive tax, punitive rate, punitive policy, punitive approach, punishing schedule, punishing pace, punishing workload, punishing conditions, punishing heat, punishing cost, punishing interest rate, go unpunished, with impunity.

Meaning in this passage

> If a blouse arrives with sleeves far longer than expected, or a pair of jeans fits differently from the chart, the customer **feels punished for trusting us**.

Here, **punished** is **figurative**.

It does **not** mean that Fast Fashion formally disciplines the customer or deliberately gives them a legal/official penalty.

It means:

the customer suffers an unfair negative consequence because they trusted the company — 覺得自己因為信任公司反而受到懲罰 / 吃虧

The customer:

1. trusts the product photos and size chart,
2. buys the item,
3. discovers that it does not match reasonable expectations,
4. is then refused exchange/refund.

Therefore the customer may feel:

> “I trusted you, and **I am the one who suffers for it**.”

feel punished for trusting us = 覺得自己只是因為信任我們，反而被迫承受不公平的後果

中文翻譯：

如果一件上衣的袖子比預期長得多，或牛仔褲實際穿起來與尺碼表所示不同，顧客便會覺得自己**只是因為信任我們，反而受到懲罰 / 吃了虧**。

A. PUNISH = GIVE SOMEONE A PENALTY

1. **punish someone = impose a penalty because they did something wrong — 懲罰某人；處罰某人**

This is the core literal meaning.

Practice 1

> The school **punished the student** for cheating.

學校因學生作弊而**處罰他**。

Practice 2

> Employees should not be punished without a fair investigation.

沒有公平調查前，不應**處罰員工**。

MCQ-ready definition:

punish = 因某人的錯誤、違規或不當行為而令他承受不利後果

2. **punish someone for something — 因某事懲罰某人**

Very important grammar.

Practice 1

> He was **punished for his behaviour**.

他因自己的行為而**受到懲罰**。

Practice 2

> Customers should not be punished for an error in the company's size chart.

顧客不應因公司的尺碼表出錯而**受到懲罰**。

Pattern:

> **punish + person + for + noun**

3. **punish someone for doing something — 因某人做某事而懲罰他**

Practice 1

> She was punished **for breaking the rule**.

她因**違反規則**而受到處罰。

Practice 2

> Genuine customers should not be punished **for reporting a defect**.

真正的顧客不應因**報告產品缺陷**而吃虧。

Pattern:

> **punish + person + for + -ing**

Important distinction 1: **punish for vs punish because**

Natural:

> punish someone **for doing X**

Possible but structurally different:

> punish someone **because they did X**

The **for + -ing/noun** construction is extremely common.

B. BE PUNISHED

4. **be punished = receive a penalty — 受到懲罰**

Practice 1

> Anyone who deliberately abuses the system may **be punished**.

任何故意濫用制度的人都可能**受到處罰**。

Practice 2

> The child was punished for lying.

孩子因說謊而**受到懲罰**。

5. **be punished severely/harshly — 受到嚴厲處罰**

Practice 1

> Serious misconduct may be **punished severely**.

嚴重不當行為可能會被**嚴厲處罰**。

Practice 2

> Minor mistakes should not automatically be punished harshly.

輕微錯誤不應自動受到**嚴厲懲罰**。

C. PUNISH = MAKE SOMEONE SUFFER AN UNFAIR CONSEQUENCE

6. **punish someone figuratively = cause them to suffer for something that may not deserve

punishment — 使某人因某事吃虧**

This is the **exact passage branch**.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The customer **feels punished for trusting us**.

顧客覺得自己只是因為信任我們，反而**受到懲罰 / 吃了虧**。

Practice 2

> The policy should not **punish honest customers for the behaviour of a few dishonest ones**.

政策不應因少數不誠實顧客的行為而令**誠實顧客受罰**。

Practice 3

> A rigid process may punish people who made an innocent mistake.

過於僵硬的程序可能令只是無心犯錯的人**承受不公平後果**。

MCQ-ready definition:

punish = figurative: 令某人因某種選擇、情況或別人的錯誤而承受不利後果，即使他本身未必做錯

7. **punish someone for doing the right thing — 因做對的事反而吃虧**

Practice 1

> Staff should not be **punished for reporting problems honestly**.

員工不應因如實報告問題而**反受懲罰**。

Practice 2

> A bad incentive system can punish people for doing the right thing.

差劣的激勵制度可能令做正確事情的人**反而吃虧**。

8. **punish customers — 令顧客承受不公平成本 / 後果**

Practice 1

> A blanket rule may unintentionally **punish genuine customers**.

一刀切規則可能無意中**令真正顧客受害 / 吃虧**。

Practice 2

> Higher fees can punish low-value customers disproportionately.

較高收費可能令低消費額顧客承受**不成比例的負擔**。

Important distinction 2: **literal punishment vs figurative punishment**

Literal:

> The school punished him for cheating.

There is:

- * authority,
- * wrongdoing,
- * deliberate penalty.

Figurative:

> The policy punishes careful customers.

There may be:

- * no wrongdoing,
- * no intention to penalize,
- * simply an unfair adverse effect.

Your passage is clearly the **figurative** use.

D. PUNISH YOURSELF

9. **punish yourself** = deliberately make yourself suffer because you feel guilty — 懲罰自己；折磨自己

Practice 1

> Do not ****punish yourself for one mistake****.

不要因一次錯誤而****懲罰自己****。

Practice 2

> He kept punishing himself for a decision he could no longer change.

他一直因一個已無法改變的決定而****自責、折磨自己****。

This may be:

- * literal self-denial,
- * emotional self-blame,
- * figurative self-imposed suffering.

Important distinction 3: ****punish yourself vs blame yourself****

****blame yourself****

believe the fault is yours.

****punish yourself****

make yourself suffer because of that perceived fault.

So:

- > blame = judgment of responsibility
- > punish = adverse consequence.

E. PUNISHMENT

10. ****punishment = penalty imposed for wrongdoing — 懲罰；處罰****

Practice 1

> The punishment should fit the offence.

****處罰****應與違規程度相稱。

Practice 2

> The manager thought the punishment was too severe.

經理認為這項**懲罰**太嚴厲。

MCQ-ready definition:

punishment = 因違規、犯罪或錯誤行為而施加的不利後果

11. **a punishment — 一項懲罰**

Countable when referring to a particular penalty.

Practice 1

> The teacher gave him a punishment.

老師給了他一項**處罰**。

Practice 2

> Losing access permanently would be a very severe punishment.

永久失去使用權會是一項非常嚴厲的**懲罰**。

12. **punishment uncountable — 懲罰這個概念 / 待遇**

Practice 1

> The behaviour deserves punishment.

這種行為應受**處罰**。

Practice 2

> Fear of punishment may deter some misconduct.

對**懲罰**的恐懼可能阻止部分不當行為。

So **punishment** can be:

* countable: a particular penalty,

* uncountable: punishment generally.

F. RECEIVE / FACE / ESCAPE PUNISHMENT

13. **receive punishment — 接受 / 受到懲罰**

Practice 1

> Those responsible received punishment.

負責的人**受到處罰**。

Practice 2

> The severity of punishment varied.

處罰的嚴厲程度有所不同。

14. **face punishment — 面臨懲罰**

Practice 1

> Employees who falsify records may **face punishment**.

偽造紀錄的員工可能**面臨處罰**。

Practice 2

> Serious violations can result in disciplinary punishment.

嚴重違規可能導致**紀律處分**。

15. **escape punishment — 逃過懲罰**

Practice 1

> He broke the rule but **escaped punishment**.

他違反規則，但**逃過了處罰**。

Practice 2

> People should not assume that misconduct will always escape punishment.

人們不應以為不當行為總能**逃避懲罰**。

16. **go unpunished — 未受懲罰**

Practice 1

> Serious misconduct should not **go unpunished**.

嚴重不當行為不應**不受懲罰**。

Practice 2

> The violation went unpunished.

這次違規最後**沒有受到處罰**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****go unpunished = 做錯事後沒有受到任何懲罰****

G. APPROPRIATE / PROPORTIONATE PUNISHMENT

17. **appropriate punishment — 適當處罰**

Practice 1

> Managers should choose an **appropriate punishment**.

管理人員應選擇**適當的處罰**。

Practice 2

> The appropriate response depends on seriousness and context.

合適的處理方式取決於嚴重程度和具體情況。

18. **proportionate punishment — 相稱的處罰**

Direct link to your **proportion** family.

Practice 1

> Punishment should be **proportionate to the offence**.

處罰應與違規程度**相稱**。

Practice 2

> A permanent ban may be disproportionate for a first minor violation.

對首次輕微違規而言，永久禁用可能是**過度處罰**。

H. DISCIPLINARY PUNISHMENT

19. **disciplinary punishment/action — 紀律處分**

Practice 1

> Repeated misconduct may lead to **disciplinary action**.

反覆不當行為可能導致**紀律處分**。

Practice 2

> Formal punishment should follow a clear disciplinary process.

正式**紀律處罰**應遵循清晰程序。

Usage note:

In workplace English, **disciplinary action** is often more natural than **disciplinary punishment**.

I. CORPORAL PUNISHMENT

20. **corporal punishment = physical punishment — 體罰**

Practice 1

> **Corporal punishment** means physical punishment imposed on a person.

****體罰****指以身體方式施加的懲罰。

Practice 2

> The expression is distinct from ordinary disciplinary penalties such as suspension or fines.

這個詞與停職、罰款等一般紀律處分不同。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****corporal punishment = 以身體疼痛或身體方式作為懲罰手段的處罰****

J. CAPITAL PUNISHMENT

21. ****capital punishment = legal death penalty — 死刑****

Practice 1

> ****Capital punishment**** means punishment by death under a legal system.

****死刑****指法律制度下以死亡作為刑罰。

Practice 2

> “Capital punishment” is a formal synonym for “the death penalty.”

****capital punishment**** 是 ****death penalty**** 的正式說法。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****capital punishment = 由國家法律制度施加的死刑****

K. COLLECTIVE PUNISHMENT

22. ****collective punishment = punishing a group for acts attributed to some members — 集體懲罰****

Practice 1

> A policy that penalises every customer for the misconduct of a few can feel like ****collective punishment****.

因少數人的不當行為而令所有顧客受罰，可能令人覺得像****集體懲罰****。

Practice 2

> Collective punishment treats a broader group as liable for conduct not committed by every member.

****集體懲罰****把更大的群體一起處罰，即使並非每個成員都做錯事。

This concept is particularly relevant to the logic of your passage.

Important distinction 4: ****collective punishment vs general rule****

A strict rule applied to everyone is ****not automatically**** collective punishment.

The phrase usually emphasizes:

> a group suffers because of wrongdoing attributed to some others.

Chris's argument is rhetorically similar:

> do not make all honest customers bear the cost of abuse by a minority.

L. PUNISHABLE

23. ****punishable = able to be legally/formally punished — 可受處罰的****

Practice 1

> The offence is ****punishable by a fine****.

該罪行****可處罰款****。

Practice 2

> Serious misconduct may be punishable under company rules.

嚴重不當行為可能按照公司規則****受到處分****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****punishable = 根據法律或規則可以被處罰的****

24. **punishable offence — 可處罰的罪行 / 違規行為**

Practice 1

> Fraud is a **punishable offence**.

欺詐是**可受法律處罰的罪行**。

Practice 2

> The precise punishment depends on the applicable rules or law.

具體處罰取決於適用的規則或法律。

25. **punishable by + penalty — 可處以.....**

Very common legal grammar.

Practice 1

> The offence is **punishable by imprisonment**.

該罪行**可處監禁**。

Practice 2

> The violation is punishable by a fine.

該違規行為**可處罰款**。

Pattern:

> **punishable by + punishment**

Important distinction 5: **punished by vs punishable by**

punished by

actual punishment happened:

> He was punished by a fine.

punishable by

the rules/law permit that punishment:

> The offence is punishable by a fine.

Possible penalty ≠ actual penalty.

M. PUNITIVE

26. **punitive = intended to punish — 懲罰性的**

A major high-level derivative.

Practice 1

> The policy should protect the company without becoming **punitive** toward genuine customers.

政策應保護公司，但不應變成對真正顧客具有**懲罰性**。

Practice 2

> The measure was designed as a punitive response to repeated abuse.

這項措施被設計成對反覆濫用行為的**懲罰性回應**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****punitive = 目的在於懲罰，或嚴厲程度帶有明顯懲罰意味的****

27. **punitive measure — 懲罰性措施**

Practice 1

> A permanent ban would be a highly **punitive measure**.

永久禁用會是一項非常**嚴厲的懲罰性措施**。

Practice 2

> Preventive safeguards do not have to be punitive.

預防性保障措施不一定需要帶有**懲罰性**。

28. **punitive action** — 懲罰性行動

Practice 1

> Management took **punitive action** after repeated deliberate abuse.

在反覆故意濫用後，管理層採取了**懲罰性措施**。

Practice 2

> Corrective action and punitive action serve different purposes.

糾正措施和**懲罰性措施**的目的不同。

Important distinction 6: **punitive vs preventive**

punitive

punishes after wrongdoing.

preventive

tries to stop harm before it happens.

In your passage:

> tamper-evident tags

> inspection

> return limits

are mainly:

preventive safeguards

not necessarily:

punitive measures.

Important distinction 7: **punitive vs corrective**

punitive

focuses on penalty.

corrective

focuses on fixing behaviour/problem.

Example:

> punitive response = suspension

> corrective response = retraining

They can coexist, but are conceptually different.

N. PUNITIVE PENALTY / FINE / CHARGE

29. **punitive penalty — very severe penalty intended to punish — 懲罰性處罰**

Practice 1

> The fee should cover actual costs rather than become a **punitive penalty**.

費用應補償實際成本，而不是變成**懲罰性罰款**。

Practice 2

> Excessively punitive penalties may discourage legitimate complaints.

過度嚴厲的**懲罰措施**可能令人不敢提出合理投訴。

30. **punitive fine — 懲罰性 / 高額罰款**

Practice 1

> The regulator imposed a **punitive fine**.

監管機構施加了一筆**懲罰性罰款**。

Practice 2

> “Punitive” emphasizes punishment rather than mere cost recovery.

****punitive**** 強調的是懲戒，而不只是收回成本。

31. ****punitive charge / fee — 懲罰性收費；高得帶懲罰意味的費用****

Practice 1

> A very high return fee could feel ****punitive****.

非常高的退貨費可能令人覺得具有****懲罰性****。

Practice 2

> Charges should be proportionate rather than punitive.

收費應保持****合乎比例****，而不是帶有懲罰意味。

This is highly relevant to consumer-policy English.

O. PUNITIVE DAMAGES

32. ****punitive damages — 懲罰性損害賠償****

An important legal compound.

Practice 1

> ****Punitive damages**** are designed primarily to punish particularly wrongful conduct rather than merely compensate for loss.

****懲罰性損害賠償****的主要目的在於懲罰特別嚴重的不當行為，而不只是補償損失。

Practice 2

> Availability and rules for punitive damages depend on the legal system.

是否可判以及如何判處****懲罰性損害賠償****取決於相關法律制度。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****punitive damages = 法律上以懲罰和阻嚇特別嚴重不當行為為主要目的的額外損害賠償****

Important distinction 8: **punitive damages vs compensatory damages**

compensatory damages

aim primarily to compensate the injured party for loss.

punitive damages

aim primarily to punish/deter serious misconduct.

Different legal functions.

P. PUNITIVE TAX / RATE / COST

33. **punitive = so high/severe that it feels like punishment — 高得帶懲罰性的；苛刻的**

A broader figurative adjective sense.

Practice 1

> The business faced **punitive borrowing costs**.

企業面對**極其高昂、近乎懲罰性的借貸成本**。

Practice 2

> The fee was so high that customers regarded it as punitive.

費用高得令顧客覺得那是一種**懲罰**。

Here **punitive** may describe severity even when punishment is not the formal legal purpose.

Q. PUNISHING = VERY DEMANDING / HARSH

34. **punishing = extremely difficult, severe or exhausting — 嚴酷的；非常吃力的**

This is a major adjective sense distinct from literal punishment.

Practice 1

> The employees faced a **punishing workload**.

員工面對**極其沉重的工作量**。

Practice 2

> They maintained a punishing schedule during the launch.

產品推出期間，他們維持一個**令人筋疲力竭的日程**。

MCQ-ready definition:

punishing = 嚴酷到令人非常疲累、難以承受或付出很大代價的

35. **punishing schedule — 極繁重的日程**

Practice 1

> The manager worked a **punishing schedule**.

經理的工作日程**極其繁重**。

Practice 2

> A punishing schedule can lead to exhaustion.

高強度日程可能令人筋疲力竭。

36. **punishing pace — 極快 / 令人難以承受的節奏**

Practice 1

> The team worked at a **punishing pace**.

團隊以**極高強度的節奏**工作。

Practice 2

> Fast-fashion production can operate at a punishing pace.

快時尚生產可能以**極其緊迫的節奏**運作。

37. ****punishing workload — 極重的工作量****

Practice 1

> Returns created a ****punishing workload**** for warehouse staff.

退貨為倉庫員工帶來****極其沉重的工作量****。

Practice 2

> Better procedures could reduce the punishing workload.

更好的程序可以減輕****難以承受的工作負擔****。

38. ****punishing conditions — 嚴酷條件****

Practice 1

> Workers operated in ****punishing conditions****.

工人在****極其嚴酷的環境****下工作。

Practice 2

> The race took place in punishing heat.

比賽在****酷熱難耐的天氣****下舉行。

Important distinction 9: ****punishing vs punitive****

These are often confused.

****punitive****

intended to punish / designed as punishment:

> punitive penalty

> punitive policy

****punishing****

extremely demanding/severe:

- > punishing workload
- > punishing schedule

So:

- > **punitive workload** ❌ usually strange
- > **punishing workload** ✅

R. PUNISHING COST / RATE

39. **punishing cost = extremely burdensome cost** — 沉重得難以承受的成本

Practice 1

- > Small businesses faced **punishing energy costs**.

小型企業面對**極其沉重的能源成本**。

Practice 2

- > Excessive return processing can create punishing costs.

過多退貨處理可能造成**沉重得難以承受的成本**。

40. **punishing interest rate** — 極高、負擔沉重的利率

Practice 1

- > The borrower faced a **punishing interest rate**.

借款人面對**極高而沉重的利率負擔**。

Practice 2

- > “Punishing” here means financially severe, not that the rate literally disciplines someone.

這裡 **punishing** 指**財務上非常沉重**，不是正式懲罰。

S. PUNITIVELY

41. ****punitively = in a punitive manner — 以懲罰方式；懲罰性地****

Practice 1

> The company should not treat genuine mistakes ****punitively****.

公司不應以****懲罰方式****處理真正的無心錯誤。

Practice 2

> The charge was set punitively high.

費用被定得****高得帶有懲罰意味****。

Less common than the adjective ****punitive****, but useful for recognition.

T. IMPUNITY

42. ****with impunity = without being punished — 不受懲罰地；逍遙法外地****

A useful lexical relative.

Practice 1

> Customers should not be able to abuse the system ****with impunity****.

顧客不應可以****毫無後果地****濫用制度。

Practice 2

> Serious misconduct cannot be allowed to continue with impunity.

不能讓嚴重不當行為****不受懲罰地持續下去****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****with impunity = 做了錯事後完全不用擔心懲罰或負面後果****

43. ****enjoy impunity / act with impunity — 免受懲罰****

Practice 1

> No employee should be able to falsify records with impunity.

任何員工都不應能夠偽造紀錄而**毋須承受後果**。

Practice 2

> Impunity can encourage repeated misconduct.

不受懲罰可能助長反覆的不當行為。

Important distinction 10: **impunity vs immunity**

impunity

freedom from punishment for wrongdoing.

immunity

protection/exemption from:

- * disease,
 - * legal process,
 - * liability,
- depending on context.

They are not interchangeable.

U. PUNISH VS PENALIZE

Important distinction 11: **punish vs penalize**

punish

broader and often human/behavioural:

- > punish a child
- > punish misconduct

penalize

impose a disadvantage/penalty under rules:

- > penalize late submissions
- > penalize customers with extra fees

In your passage:

> **feel punished**

is more emotional and rhetorically powerful than:

> *feel penalized.*

V. PUNISH VS DISCIPLINE

Important distinction 12: **punish vs discipline**

punish

focuses on imposing an adverse consequence.

discipline

can mean:

1. impose formal corrective sanctions;
2. train/control behaviour;
3. self-control.

Good discipline is not necessarily only punishment.

W. PUNISH VS SANCTION

Important distinction 13: **punish vs sanction**

punish

verb describing the act of imposing suffering/penalty.

sanction (noun)

formal penalty imposed for violating rules/law.

Example:

- > punish the offender
- > impose sanctions

****Sanction**** can also mean official approval in another sense, so context matters.

X. PUNISH VS FINE

****fine****

specifically impose a monetary penalty.

****punish****

much broader.

- > fine someone \$500
- > 罰款

is one possible way to:

- > punish someone.

Important distinction 14: ****punishment vs penalty****

****punishment****

broader concept of making someone suffer consequences for wrongdoing.

****penalty****

specific adverse consequence imposed under a rule.

Examples:

- * fine,
- * suspension,
- * points deduction,
- * extra charge.

A penalty is often a form of punishment, but ****penalty**** sounds more rule-based and technical.

Y. PUNISH VS RETALIATE

punish

respond to wrongdoing under some claimed authority/standard.

retaliate

strike back because someone harmed/angered you.

Retaliation may itself be improper.

> punish rule-breaking

> ≠

> retaliate against criticism.

Z. PUNISH VS REVENGE

punishment

may be institutional and intended to enforce rules.

revenge

personal act motivated by desire to get back at someone.

They can feel similar emotionally, but the concepts differ.

AA. PUNISH VS CORRECT

correct

fix behaviour/error.

punish

impose adverse consequences.

Good policy may seek:

> corrective action

rather than:

> purely punitive action.

This distinction strongly fits your passage.

AB. PUNISH VS DETER

punish

impose consequence after or because of misconduct.

deter

discourage someone from doing it.

Punishment can be used to deter, but:

> punishment = mechanism/action

> deterrence = intended/preventive effect.

AC. PUNISH VS PREVENT

prevent

stop something from happening.

punish

respond after wrongdoing or impose adverse consequences.

The proposed system uses:

> safeguards to **prevent** misuse,

rather than simply:

> punish everyone because misuse might happen.

That is central to Chris's logic.

AD. PUNISH VS BLAME

blame

hold someone responsible.

punish

impose consequence.

Someone may:

> be blamed but not punished,

or:

> feel punished despite not being blamed.

The latter is close to the passage.

AE. PUNISH VS HARM

harm

cause damage/suffering, whether intentional or accidental.

punish

usually suggests suffering connected to:

- * wrongdoing,
- * a supposed penalty,
- * or figuratively an unfair consequence.

A policy may:

> harm customers

without feeling specifically:

> punitive.

But Chris says ****punished**** because it emphasizes the unfairness:

> “They trusted us, yet they suffer as though they had done something wrong.”

AF. PUNISH VS SUFFER

You curated ****suffer**** earlier.

****suffer****

experience something bad.

****be punished****

experience something bad specifically as a penalty or as though it were one.

Compare:

> The customer suffers inconvenience.

> 顧客承受不便。

> The customer feels punished for trusting us.

> 顧客覺得自己因信任公司而****反受懲罰****。

The second adds a strong sense of:

****unfair moral reversal****.

AG. PUNISHMENT VS CONSEQUENCE

****consequence****

any result, good or bad.

****punishment****

negative consequence imposed because of wrongdoing.

Therefore:

> every punishment is a negative consequence,

but:

> not every negative consequence is punishment.

In the passage the customer ****feels**** punished even though formally it is only:

> a consequence of the policy.

AH. "FEEL PUNISHED" VS "BE PUNISHED"

Important distinction 15

****be punished****

states that punishment actually occurs.

****feel punished****

describes the person's perception/experience.

The passage carefully says:

> customer ****feels punished****

rather than:

> company ****punishes the customer****.

Why?

Because Chris is describing the ****customer experience****:

> the outcome feels unfairly punitive,

even if management did not deliberately intend punishment.

AI. PASSAGE-SPECIFIC: PUNISHED FOR TRUSTING US

This wording is rhetorically powerful because ****trusting a business is not wrongdoing****.

Normally:

- > punish someone ****for cheating****
- > makes logical sense.

But:

- > punish someone ****for trusting us****

creates deliberate moral irony:

The customer did the thing the business wants—trusted the photos, chart and description—yet the policy makes that trust costly.

That supports Chris's claim that the existing rule can:

- * reduce confidence,
- * produce frustration,
- * damage repeat business.

Important distinction 16: ****punish honest customers vs punish abuse****

The letter's balance is:

legitimate:

- > take action against genuine abuse.

problematic:

- > make every honest customer suffer because abuse is possible.

So Chris is not saying:

- > "Never punish misuse."

He is saying:

- > ****anti-abuse measures should target misuse rather than indiscriminately burden genuine customers.****

AJ. PUNITIVE VS PROPORTIONATE — PASSAGE LINK

Your earlier word was ****proportion****.

These combine naturally:

****proportionate response****

appropriately matched to risk.

****punitive response****

aimed strongly at punishment.

A policy can be:

> strict but proportionate

or:

> excessively punitive and disproportionate.

Chris's proposed system aims for:

> ****firm against abuse, but not punitive toward honest customers.****

AK. PUNISHMENT FITS THE OFFENCE

44. ****the punishment should fit the crime/offence — 罰當其罪；處罰應與過錯相稱****

A very common principle/idiom.

Practice 1

> The punishment should ****fit the offence****.

處罰應與過錯的嚴重程度****相稱****。

Practice 2

> A lifetime ban for one innocent mistake would not make the punishment fit the offence.

因一次無心錯誤而永久禁用，便很難說是****罰當其罪****。

This links strongly with:

> proportionality.

AL. PUNISHING AS “HARD ON THE BODY”

45. **punishing = physically exhausting — 對身體非常吃力的**

Practice 1

> The runners completed a **punishing course**.

跑手完成了一條**非常艱辛的賽道**。

Practice 2

> Warehouse staff worked through a punishing shift.

倉庫員工完成了一個**極其辛苦的班次**。

No actual discipline is implied.

AM. PUNISHING CONDITIONS IN BUSINESS

46. **punishing conditions = commercially or operationally severe conditions — 極嚴酷的經營環境**

Practice 1

> Small retailers faced **punishing market conditions**.

小型零售商面對**極其嚴峻的市場環境**。

Practice 2

> High costs and weak demand created punishing conditions.

高成本和需求疲弱造成**非常艱難的經營環境**。

AN. PUNITIVE POLICY

47. **punitive policy = policy that heavily penalizes people — 懲罰性政策**

Practice 1

> A returns system should not become a **punitive policy** toward genuine customers.

退貨制度不應變成針對真正顧客的**懲罰性政策**。

Practice 2

> A policy may be described as punitive when its burdens seem designed mainly to punish rather than solve the problem.

如果政策的負擔看來主要是為了懲罰，而不是解決問題，就可能被形容為 **punitive**。

AO. PUNITIVE APPROACH

48. **punitive approach — 懲罰式做法**

Practice 1

> A purely **punitive approach** may not address the cause of the problem.

單純採取**懲罰式做法**未必能處理問題根源。

Practice 2

> Management chose prevention and monitoring over an entirely punitive approach.

管理層選擇預防和監察，而不是完全採取**懲罰性手段**。

AP. PUNISHABLE VS PUNITIVE

Important distinction 17

punishable

describes the **wrongdoing**:

> punishable offence

> 可受處罰的罪行

punitive

describes the **response/measure**:

> punitive penalty

> 懲罰性處罰

So:

> offence = punishable

> measure = punitive

AQ. PUNISHED VS PUNISHING

Important distinction 18

punished

someone receives punishment:

> punished employee

punishing

something is extremely severe/demanding:

> punishing workload

Do not say:

> *a punished workload* ❌

AR. PUNISHING VS HARSH

harsh

broad:

* severe,

* unpleasant,

* cruel,

* rough.

punishing

specifically emphasizes:

> very demanding or exhausting.

> harsh criticism

> natural

> punishing schedule

> natural

AS. PUNITIVE VS HARSH

harsh

may simply be severe.

punitive

suggests:

* intention to punish,

* or punishment-like severity.

A harsh rule is not automatically punitive.

AT. PUNISHMENT VS DISCIPLINARY ACTION — WORKPLACE

For workplace/business writing:

more neutral/professional:

> disciplinary action

stronger/more general:

> punishment

So:

> Staff who abuse the refund process may face disciplinary action.

usually sounds more professional than:

> Staff may receive punishment.

AU. IMPUNITY VS GO UNPUNISHED

Very close:

go unpunished

verb phrase:

> The misconduct went unpunished.

with impunity

adverbial phrase:

> They acted with impunity.

The second often implies:

repeated confidence that there will be no consequences.

AV. COUNTABILITY: PUNISHMENT

As noted:

Uncountable

> Punishment should be proportionate.

Countable

> That was a severe punishment.

But **punish** itself is always a verb:

> punish someone 

> *a punish* 

AW. GRAMMAR PATTERNS

The most important patterns are:

punish + person

> punish the offender

punish + person + for + noun

> punish someone for misconduct

punish + person + for + -ing

> punish someone for breaking the rule

be punished + for

> be punished for fraud

punishable + by

> punishable by a fine

punitive + noun

> punitive measure

> punitive charge

punishing + noun

> punishing schedule

> punishing workload

AX. WORD-FAMILY SEMANTIC MAP

The family divides neatly into three branches:

1. **Actual punishment**

* punish

- * punishment
- * punishable

2. **Punishment-oriented**

- * punitive
- * punitively

3. **Punishment-like severity**

- * punishing

And the opposite idea:

4. **absence of punishment**

- * impunity
- * go unpunished

These should not be merged.

Family-extension note

The **punish** family has several major modern branches:

1. **formal penalty**

- * punish someone
- * be punished

2. **reason for punishment**

- * punish for
- * punish for doing

3. **figurative adverse consequence**

- * feel punished
- * punish honest customers

4. **self-directed punishment**

- * punish yourself

5. **noun**

* punishment

6. **degree of punishment**

* severe punishment

* proportionate punishment

7. **institutional discipline**

* disciplinary punishment/action

8. **physical punishment**

* corporal punishment

9. **legal death penalty**

* capital punishment

10. **group-wide penalty**

* collective punishment

11. **legal/formal eligibility for penalty**

* punishable

* punishable by...

12. **punishment-oriented measures**

* punitive measure

* punitive approach

13. **legal damages**

* punitive damages

14. **punishment-like charges**

* punitive fine

* punitive fee

15. **extreme severity**

- * punishing workload
- * punishing schedule
- * punishing conditions

16. **freedom from punishment**

- * impunity
- * with impunity
- * go unpunished

For your passage, the exact branch is:

feel punished = experience the policy's negative consequences as though one were being penalized, despite having done nothing wrong

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
punish	懲罰；處罰	core verb
punish someone	懲罰某人	penalty
punish someone for X	因 X 懲罰某人	reason
punish someone for doing X	因做 X 而懲罰	grammar
be punished	受到懲罰	passive
feel punished	覺得自己像被懲罰	passage sense
punish honest customers	令誠實顧客吃虧	figurative
punish yourself	懲罰 / 折磨自己	self-directed
punishment	懲罰；處罰	noun
a punishment	一項懲罰	countable
face punishment	面臨懲罰	consequence
escape punishment	逃過懲罰	avoidance
go unpunished	沒有受到懲罰	absence
appropriate punishment	適當處罰	degree
proportionate punishment	相稱處罰	proportionality
disciplinary action	紀律處分	workplace
corporal punishment	體罰	physical
capital punishment	死刑	legal
collective punishment	集體懲罰	group
punishable	可受懲罰的	adjective
punishable offence	可處罰罪行	legal
punishable by a fine	可處罰款	legal grammar
punitive	懲罰性的	response/measure
punitive measure	懲罰性措施	policy
punitive action	懲罰性行動	enforcement

punitive fine	懲罰性罰款	money	
punitive charge	懲罰性收費	fee	
punitive damages	懲罰性損害賠償	law	
punitive policy	懲罰性政策	policy	
punitive approach	懲罰式做法	strategy	
punitively	懲罰性地	adverb	
punishing	嚴酷、吃力的	severity	
punishing schedule	極繁重日程	workload	
punishing pace	極高強度節奏	pace	
punishing workload	極重工作量	work	
punishing conditions	嚴酷條件	environment	
punishing cost	極沉重成本	finance	
with impunity	不受懲罰地	no consequences	
impunity	免受懲罰	noun	
punishment fits the offence	罰當其罪	proportionality	

For your original sentence

> If a blouse arrives with sleeves far longer than expected, or a pair of jeans fits differently from the chart, the customer **feels punished for trusting us**.

Here:

punished = 顧客明明沒有做錯事，只是合理地相信公司的照片、尺碼表和描述，卻因公司的嚴格政策而由自己承擔所有不利後果，因此感覺像被懲罰一樣

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 如果上衣的袖子比預期長很多，或牛仔褲實際穿起來與尺碼表所示不同，顧客便會覺得自己**只是因為信任我們，反而受到懲罰 / 吃了虧**。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

- > **punish** = 因某事使人承受懲罰
- > **penalize** = 按制度給予不利處分 / 扣罰
- > **discipline** = 紀律處分或行為管教
- > **fine** = 罰款
- > **blame** = 歸咎，不一定處罰
- > **harm** = 傷害，不一定有懲罰意味
- > **suffer** = 承受不利事情，不一定是被罰
- > **punitive** = **懲罰性的措施 / 做法**
- > **punishing** = **嚴酷、令人難以承受的條件 / 工作量**
- > **punishable** = **可依法 / 按規則受處罰的**

And the strongest passage-specific contrast is:

- > ****punish abuse****
- > can be legitimate,

but:

- > ****punish honest customers for trusting accurate-looking information****
- > is exactly the unfair outcome Chris wants the revised policy to avoid.